UNION · MEN'S BIBLE STUDY & MARRIAGE MINISTRY

When Suffering Speaks: Four Questions from Romans 8

Adapted from Kevin Carson, "Four Questions Every Counselor Must Be Able to Answer Regarding Suffering," Biblical Counseling Coalition

Suffering tempts us to read God's character off our circumstances instead of reading our circumstances through what God has already revealed about Himself. In Romans 8:31–39, Paul answers with four questions every believer needs to be able to answer.

1. **"If God is for us, who can be against us?"**
   Paul never promises no one will oppose us — hard seasons can make it feel like God Himself is against us. Paul redirects us: look at the cross, not the circumstances. Our situation doesn't decide whether God is for us.

2. **"Will He not also give us all things?"**
   Since God already gave His Son, He can be trusted to supply what's actually needed — even, and especially, in suffering.

3. **"Who shall bring a charge... who is to condemn?"**
   God justifies; Christ does not condemn. No accusation — from ourselves or anyone else — can stick.

4. **"Who shall separate us from the love of Christ?"**
   God is for us. God justifies us. Christ does not condemn us. Nothing can separate us from His love.

> **FOR US, AS MEN**
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> A man shut out by his wife, passed over at work, or brushed off by his kids does exactly what Paul warns against — reads rejection as a verdict: *she's distant, so I'm not worth pursuing; I got passed over, so I'm not capable; my kid brushed me off, so I don't matter.* Paul interrupts that chain: your standing isn't inferred from what's happening to you — it's fixed by what already happened *for* you at the cross. Rejection can be grieved; it can't be the final word on a man's worth.

DISCUSSION

1. Where have you let a rejection — from your wife, your job, your kids — quietly become a verdict on who you are?
2. Which of the four questions above is hardest for you to actually believe right now, and why?
3. What would it look like this week to answer that verdict with the cross instead of with performance, withdrawal, or resentment?